

HISTORY: ASIA

- ASIA**
- came from Aegean word ASER which means "SUNRISE".
 - The term Asia was first used by Pindar, a Greek poet.
 - Formerly called Far East.

GEOGRAPHICAL FEATURES

- world's largest continent
- 17, 139,000 sq. miles (nearly 1/3 of the land surface of the earth)
- World's populous continent (about 60% of the world's pop. is in Asia)

BOUNDARIES

N - Arctic Ocean

S - Indian Ocean

E - Pacific Ocean

W - Ural Mountains, Caspian Sea, Black Sea and Aegean Sea

-It is separated from N. America by the narrow Bering Strait and from Africa by Suez Canal. In SE, it is connected by tropical islands to Australia.

GEOGRAPHICAL REGIONS

CENTRAL NORTH ASIA -Afghanistan, Mongolian People's Rep. and Siberia and Soviet Central Asia

SOUTH ASIA- centered on Indian Sub-continent that comprises: India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Bhutan, Nepal, Sikkim and Maldives

EAST ASIA- called as FAR EAST by the westerners, because it is part of Asia which is farthest east of Europe. This includes China, Taiwan (formerly FORMOSA), Korea and Japan

SOUTHWEST ASIA OR MIDDLE EAST – It is also called by Europeans as NEAR EAST due to its nearest location to Europe. Sometimes they called this as MIDDLE EAST for it is midway between Europe and East Asia.

South West comprises: Iran (Persia), Iraq(Mesopotamia), Syria, Lebanon (Phoenicia), Turkey (Asia Minor), Jordan, Israel, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait (former prov. of Iraq), Bahrain, (Garden of Eden) Qatar, U.A.E., Oman, and Yemen

SOUTH EAST ASIA

It covers: Philippines, Indonesia, Malaysia, Singapore, Thailand (Siam), Burma(Myanmar), Cambodia (Kampuchea), Brunei Darussalam, Laos and Vietnam

ASIAN ASIA

The part of the continent that has significant historical, cultural, agricultural and climatic criteria that set it apart from other continental areas despite the elements of cultural convergence that characterize the various worldwide processes of modernization.

SOVIET ASIA

The part of Asia that is culturally oriented to and identified with Europe and therefore not Asian.

ASIA was the seat of the world's civilization. Early civilization developed in the river valleys of the ff:

- TIGRIS & EUPHRATES - Iraq
- INDUS – India
- YELLOW RIVER- China

HISTORY: ASIA

- History began in Asia where the first empires and civilization began. While the rest of the world except Egypt was still in barbaric state, Asia already developed
- Several civilizations:
 - Sumer, Babylonian, Assyrian, Chaldean, etc in Mesopotamia
 - Persia at Iranian plateau
 - China and Indian civilization
- The Persian empire was conquered by Alexander the Great in 4th century BC, but it resurrected by Sassanid Dynasty and survived until the 7th century AD, when it succumbed to Islam
- Alexander conquered southern Europe, Persia, Middle east and India. But he himself was conquered by the Asian civilization which he admired and adopted. Out of his blending of East and West came the so-called Hellenistic culture.
- Meanwhile other civilization flourished in India, China and Japan

ASIA AND THE ROMAN EMPIRE

- While the west stagnated, Asia was blaze with resplendent culture burned brightly in China, India and Arabia.
- Asians were already basking in the glory of their civilizations, making and writing history, and accumulating treasures which centuries dazzled European adventurers and colonizers.
- After Alexander, Rome became the mistress of the Western world. Roman legions conquered western Asia.
- When Rome fell in 476 AD, the barbarians smashed and plunged Europe into chaos.
- The Dark Ages-marked the intellectual eclipse and social stagnation in Europe

CONTRIBUTIONS OF ASIAN COLONIES TO WESTERN POWERS

- 1. Supplied much needed raw materials for the burgeoning manufacturing industries of Britain, France, Spain, Portugal, US and others.
- 2. Asian colonies served as lucrative markets of their colonial overlords
- 3. Asia's temples, palaces and private art collections, the western fortune hunters secured, by fair means or foul,
- 4. Asian colonies furnished their colonial masters with the necessary manpower and natural resources to win their wars, including the first and second world wars.
- The acquisition of rich colonies in Asia gave the Western nations considerable prestige in world affairs.
- US – acquired Philippines and Guam and won recognition as a world power.
- Britain-became the world's greatest power in the 19th century
- Holland-ranked a colonial world power by acquiring East Indies.

CONTRIBUTIONS OF WESTERN POWERS TO ASIAN COLONIES

- 1. They brought the blessings of the Industrial Revolution to Asia
- 2. Western missionaries propagated Christianity.
- 3. With the surging tides of Western imperialism came the arts and sciences, popular education, the Gregorian calendar, the Latin alphabet, and other legacies of Western civilization.
- 4. Western introduces democracy and communism to Asia
- 5. The impact of western civilization brought about
 - The abolition of Asia's pernicious customs and practices, such as the suttee (burning a widow on her husband's funeral) and thuggi
 - Thuggi- (strangulation of human victims to appease the goddess Kali) in India
 - Old Chinese custom of foot binding-to make the feet of women very small
 - The Purdah-wearing veil in Islamic countries
 - Japanese Seppuku- popularly known as *Harakiri*- honorable suicide by slashing one's stomach with a dagger

HISTORY: ASIA

- Westerners brought to Asia the political doctrine of nationalism which ironically inspired the Asians to free themselves from Western bondage

IRAQ: WHERE CIVILIZATION- FIRST BEGAN

- IRAQ formerly called MESOPOTAMIA means land between two rivers, the rivers of Tigris and Euphrates.
- Several ancient civilization thrived in this fertile crescent between two rivers- Sumerians, Babylonians, Assyrians, Chaldeans, and Persians.
- The first ancient civilization dawned at Sumer. They developed a high civilization which later absorbed by the Babylonians. The greatest Babylon ruler was Hammurabi founder of the empire and author of the famous Hammurabi Code.
- The warlike Assyrians dominated Mesopotamia. Then Chaldeans rose to power. Their greatest ruler was Nebuchadnezzar who built the Hanging Gardens of Babylon.
- The Persian, under Cyrus the Great, conquered Iraq in 538 BC. Then came Alexander the Great and his successors.
- In middle 7th century AD Iraq was conquered by Arabs, then fell to Seljuk Turks, the Mongols and the Ottoman Turks.

IRAQ, CONTRIBUTIONS TO CIVILIZATION

- First plow and first wheel
- They were the first people to domesticate animals
- First to develop system of writing –cuneiform
- First written laws- Code of Hammurabi
- First written literature-Epic Gilgamesh
- First astronomers-they were the first to chart the movement of the sun, moon and stars. Make the first calendar of 12 months a year and 7 days a week. They developed astrology and devised the 12 zodiac
- Mathematics was first developed in Mesopotamia. The Sumerians who were expert Mathematicians
- Devised the sexagesimal system, that is, counting by 60s. They were divided the hour into 60 minutes, and the minute into 60 seconds.
- First builders of cities, palaces, temples, and other massive structures, all of which were made of clay bricks.
- Iraq is the land of man's first downfall and pride- *the land of the Tower of Babel, of Cain the first murderer, of the people of Noah's time.*
- *Iraq was the home of false gods and religions that encourage human sacrifices, astrology, horoscopes, worships of human leaders, moon, stars and planets....*
- However, the Lord has promised to totally destroy Babylon., which was the ancient site of Iraq. (Rev. 18-21)- "Thus will Babylon," says the Bible, "the great city be thrown down with violence, and will not be found anymore."

CHINA: THE WORLD'S BIGGEST NATION

China- is the world's oldest continuing civilization, with a recorded history of 5,000 years.

Dynasties of China

1. **XIA or HSIA** – tyranny, warlords and revolution
2. **SHANG** – Had bronze metal civilization
3. **ZHOU or CHOU** – the longest ruling dynasty, feudalism was established, civil service system improved bureaucracy and philosophy flourished

CHOU DYNASTY- AGE OF PHILOSOPHERS

HISTORY: ASIA

Philosophy first began in ancient china, long before it was known in ancient Greece.

3 Great Chinese Philosophers

1. **Confucius**-greatest philosopher and teacher of china
2. **Lao Tze**- founder of Taoism
3. **Mencius**- greatest disciple of Confucius

4. **CHIN** – Shih Huang Ti ordered the construction of the Great wall of China.
5. **HAN**- marked the early peak of political and cultural development. When Rome fell in the west China became the great civilizer of Eurasia. –Buddhism was introduced and the first official records were written.
6. **TANG**- the greatest dynasty to rule China. Founded by Li Yuan. During that time China became the *mightiest empire in the world while Europe was in the Dark Ages*. This period was also known as the Golden Age of Chinese Poetry.

TU FU - China's greatest poet, became idol of the people.

6. **SUNG** –China became the greatest nation in the world.
7. **YUAN** – Genghis Khan and his Mongol holders overran north China and Russia.
 - Kublai Khan –established capital at Peking and founded the YUAN
 - Marco Polo-famous Venetian traveler visited China and his tales stirred Western interest to explore the east.
8. **MING**- (means brilliant)-China became *Mistress of the oriental Seas, and their fleets patrolled* the seas of Southeast Asia and the Indian Ocean.
9. **MANCHU** – founded by Taitsung. The 4th Manchu emperor ushered new era of prosperity. His reign surpassed that of his contemporaries such as Frederick the Great of Prussia, George III of Britain and Louis XV of France.

Chinese contributions to civilization

1. First paper, brush and ink for writing. First printing press, first gun powder for festivals and warfare and first compass and watermill.
2. Sericulture (silk industry)
3. Philosophy and Religion
4. First paper money, first newspaper in the world The Peking Gazette.
5. fan, umbrella, and paper lantern, chopsticks, kites, calligraphy and pagoda architecture.